

1978 Carolina Skiff - Restoration Log

Personal project | Workshop out back | Slow hours only

Running log on the 1978 Carolina Skiff. It is a slow project, worked on between cycles and after the day's farm work is done. No deadline; the point is the doing. Entries are dated as the work happens.

Log

Date	Work	Materials	Hours
Sep 2025	Strip old paint from hull, inspect transom	Stripper, scrapers, 80 grit	6
Oct 2025	Cut out soft transom core, dry-fit new ply	Marine ply, dust mask	5
Nov 2025	Laminate transom, epoxy and glass	Epoxy, 1708 cloth	7
Dec 2025	Fair the hull, fill low spots	Fairing compound, long board	8
Jan 2026	Prime hull, sand to 220	Epoxy primer, 220 grit	5
Feb 2026	Rebuild bench seat, sand rails	Cedar offcuts, screws	4

Punch list remaining

- Topcoat hull (waiting on a stretch of low humidity, not a hot week).
- New bilge pump and wiring; tin the connections, heat-shrink everything.
- Re-bed cleats and rub rail with butyl.
- Trailer bunks need new carpet before she goes back on.

Notes to self

The transom was worse than it looked, which is the rule with old boats. The new core is solid now. Take the time on the fairing; that is what shows in the light. Nathan wants to help with the topcoat color - let him pick.

Personal log. No timeline. Workshop shares space with farm storage; keep epoxy off the feed shelf.